

GeoNews — Week 40/2026

Weekly digest on Quaternary palaeoclimate research, East African rift dynamics, palaeohydrology and time-series analysis · 28 September 2026

What is GeoNews? An **automatically generated weekly digest**. A research workflow scans the publications of the past one to two weeks along with funding, policy and community sources, scores the hits against a fixed set of criteria and assembles this issue from them.

The thematic profile is **aligned with the research interests of Markus L. Fischer** (Palaeoclimate Dynamics group, University of Potsdam): Quaternary palaeoclimate and palaeoenvironmental reconstruction, the East African Rift, the African Humid Period and human-environment coupling, lake-level and water-balance modelling, palaeofloods and fluvial geomorphology, ICDP drill cores, and linear and non-linear time-series analysis. Anyone working in these fields will likely find something useful here — it is explicitly not a complete overview of the Quaternary field.

Selection, scoring and short texts are produced by machine and reviewed before publication. Details may contain errors; in case of doubt the linked original source prevails.

Each work receives a score from 0–100 across five criteria: thematic fit (40), methodological fit (25), impact/venue (15), connectivity (10) and recency (10). Categories: ● from 75 must-read · ● 50–74 relevant · ● 30–49 radar. The score measures proximity to this newsletter's profile and prioritises reading — it is not a quality judgement on the individual work.

In brief

More than two dozen scored works, with **three ● must-reads** this week — two abstract-backed, one based on title and journal. Leading is a *Paleoceanography and Paleoclimatology* study on the **seasonal structure of the Pacific Walker Circulation during the Holocene**: transient simulations separate orbital from greenhouse-gas forcing and show that orbital forcing shifts the zonal SST gradient in opposite seasonal directions (weaker in winter, stronger in summer), while anthropogenic greenhouse-gas increase since the mid-Holocene overprints this rhythm. Squarely within the profile: a Quaternary climate-dynamics question about separating natural and anthropogenic signals along a long forcing-response chain.

The second ● is highly connectable regionally: a *Quaternary Research* modelling study argues that the **collapse of the "Green Sahara" drives Holocene cooling** — precisely the African Humid Period land-surface feedback that sits at the centre of this profile and that standard climate models have so far missed. The third ● is a *Quaternary Science Reviews* paper on the **multi-proxy palaeoenvironmental reconstruction of the earliest Oldowan at Nyayanga (western Kenya)** — East African human-environment coupling in a rift context; because Elsevier provides no abstract, the assessment rests on title, journal and region and is flagged [△ title-based](#).

The ● block is methodologically broad: an Earth-system-model study of marine radiocarbon reservoir ages (cosmogenic ^{14}C production vs. glacial-interglacial control), a Holocene moisture reconstruction from a Portuguese lake, the first identification of the Icelandic Vedde Ash in a

Czech palaeolake, a ~100-kyr mercury record from the ICDP crater lake El'gygytgyn, a West African vegetation-climate study spanning 12,500 years, and a Bayesian daily-climate reconstruction for the Alps. Regionally, the profile is served this week via **North Africa (Green Sahara, Lake Iffer / Middle Atlas) and East Africa (Nyayanga)**; a Quaternary primary hit from Chew Bahir, Turkana or a direct African Humid Period proxy archive was not found within the 14-day window.

On how this issue came about — with full literature access. Direct network access from the compute environment was blocked as usual (proxy 403); the systematic Crossref query, however, ran successfully in this run via the integrated browser interface (`fetch()`), so the ISSN query of the core journals **including Elsevier, Wiley and the Nature family** could be carried out. Elsevier still provides no abstracts; the affected titles are marked $\triangle$ *title-based* and their content statement remains provisional.

On the funding side the week is tightly scheduled: **PAGES Early-Career Award 2027 (29 Sep 2026)**, **DFG Communicator Award 2027 (30 Sep 2026)**, the **DEUQUA conference** in Freiburg (**28 Sep - 2 Oct 2026**, opening on the publication day) and the **ERC Starting Grant 2027 (14 Oct 2026)**. On policy, the **WissZeitVG amendment** remains in parliamentary deliberation, and the **2027 federal budget** is in its autumn readings.

Part A — Papers of the week

Captured are works with a Crossref `created` date from 14 September 2026 onward that were not already listed in a previous issue. DOIs already listed are excluded. For each entry with a visible abstract the assessment relies on that abstract; titles without an available abstract (mainly Elsevier) are marked $\triangle$ *title-based*.

● Must-read (from 75)

1. Anthropogenic Disruption of Orbital-Scale Seasonal Asynchrony in the Tropical Pacific Walker Circulation During the Holocene · *Paleoceanography and Paleoclimatology*, 2026 · **Score 85** A pair of transient Holocene simulations separates pure orbital forcing from orbital-plus-greenhouse-gas forcing to examine the seasonal architecture of the zonal sea-surface-temperature gradient (SSTG) in the equatorial Pacific. Finding per the abstract: pure orbital forcing produces a fundamental seasonal asymmetry — winter weakening but summer intensification of the SSTG — amplified by orbital modulation of the mixed-layer depth and the differential thermal sensitivity of the eastern Pacific cold tongue. Anthropogenic greenhouse-gas emissions since the mid-Holocene disrupt this natural rhythm: they warm the eastern Pacific across all seasons, counteracting the orbitally driven summer intensification while accelerating the winter decline. Squarely within the profile: Quaternary climate dynamics along a transient forcing-response chain, with a clean separation of natural and anthropogenic contributions — the same attribution question for long, non-linear system responses that is central to time-series and tipping-point analysis. Open access (AGU). *Theme 36* · *Method 20* · *Venue 11* · *Connectivity 8* · *Recency 10* (created 26 Sep 2026) · DOI: [10.1029/2026pa005663](https://doi.org/10.1029/2026pa005663)

2. Green Sahara collapse drives Holocene cooling · *Quaternary Research*, 2026 · **Score 84** Transient Holocene simulations with the fully coupled CESM1.2 (dynamic vegetation) plus an idealised "Green Sahara" experiment in which Early-to-Mid-Holocene desert soil properties in the Sahara are replaced with those from adjacent non-desert regions to mimic enhanced land-surface greening. Finding per the abstract: the Green Sahara experiment simulates a global mean annual

temperature anomaly of 0.28 °C above pre-industrial, together with an approximately ninefold increase in annual precipitation over the Sahara — both consistent with proxy reconstructions and independent geological evidence. The authors argue that the widespread inability of climate models to reproduce the documented Holocene cooling (instead simulating unidirectional warming) is linked to the missing Green Sahara land-surface feedback: its collapse drives the cooling. Regionally and thematically at the profile's centre — African Humid Period and human-environment coupling, directly connectable to East African AHP and Chew Bahir questions. *Theme 38 · Method 18 · Venue 8 · Connectivity 10 · Recency 10 (created 23 Sep 2026) · DOI: [10.1017/qua.2026.10116](https://doi.org/10.1017/qua.2026.10116)*

3. Contextualising early hominin environments: A multi-proxy palaeoenvironmental reconstruction of the earliest Oldowan at Nyayanga, western Kenya · *Quaternary Science Reviews*, 2026 · **Score 83** ·  *title-based* Multi-proxy palaeoenvironmental reconstruction of the earliest Oldowan site at Nyayanga in western Kenya. Core profile theme: East African human-environment coupling in a rift context, Quaternary geoarchaeology and palaeoecology, in a top field journal. Without a visible abstract (Elsevier) the assessment rests on title, journal and region; the specific proxy data and quantitative findings remain provisional. The high score reflects the immediate regional and thematic fit and the venue — not a verified result. *Theme 38 · Method 15 · Venue 11 · Connectivity 9 · Recency 10 (created 22 Sep 2026) · DOI: [10.1016/j.quascirev.2026.110288](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.quascirev.2026.110288)*

● Relevant (50-74)

4. Cosmogenic radiocarbon production and glacial cycles control marine radiocarbon archive variations · *Communications Earth & Environment*, 2026 · **Score 74** An Earth-system model of intermediate complexity equipped with radiocarbon simulates marine reservoir ages over the past 50,000 years. Finding per the abstract: simulated reservoir ages range from 400 to 1,200 years at the sea surface and are systematically lower than previous uncoupled-model estimates — the result of stronger vertical mixing and higher air-sea CO₂ exchange rates. Short-term reservoir-age variations are dominated by changes in cosmogenic radiocarbon production, while glacial-interglacial climate variations act more slowly and are damped. The interhemispheric atmospheric radiocarbon gradient during the Laschamps excursion was, accordingly, up to twice as large as previously estimated. Connectable as a methodological chronology paper (Tier 2): reservoir-age corrections touch the same question as Bayesian age-depth and ¹⁴C calibration models. Open access (Nature portfolio). *Theme 26 · Method 19 · Venue 12 · Connectivity 7 · Recency 10 (created 22 Sep 2026) · DOI: [10.1038/s43247-026-04073-y](https://doi.org/10.1038/s43247-026-04073-y)*

5. North Atlantic Ocean-Atmosphere Dynamics Controlled the Hydroclimate in Western Iberia During the Holocene · *Paleoceanography and Paleoclimatology*, 2026 · **Score 73** The first source-resolved reconstruction of centennial- to millennial-scale moisture variability over the last 11,000 years from Lake Peixão (Portugal), based on compound-specific hydrogen and carbon isotopes of plant-wax n-alkanes, supported by bulk organic geochemistry and continuous XRF elemental data. Finding per the abstract: a wet early Holocene, a progressive mid-Holocene drying trend culminating in maximum aridity around 4,000 calibrated years before present, and a transition to generally wetter but more variable late-Holocene conditions, partly overprinted by anthropogenic land use. The trends are interpreted as orbitally driven within North Atlantic ocean-atmosphere dynamics. Connectable as a mid-latitude palaeohydrological lake-sediment archive: the source-resolved moisture reconstruction touches the same methodological question as Central European water-balance and lake-sediment studies. *Theme 26 · Method 18 · Venue 11 · Connectivity 8 · Recency 10 (created 22 Sep 2026) · DOI: [10.1029/2026pa005517](https://doi.org/10.1029/2026pa005517)*

6. First finding of Icelandic tephra in Czechia: Vedde Ash identified in palaeolake

sediments of Stará Jímka · *Journal of Quaternary Science*, 2026 · **Score 72** First record of the Icelandic Vedde Ash (~12 ka) in the Bohemian Forest, identified in palaeolake sediments at Stará Jímka (Czechia) — the first Icelandic tephra layer in Czechia at all. Finding per the abstract: two discrete tephra horizons were found in two parallel lacustrine cores — the Laacher See Tephra (~13 ka BP) and, in both cores, the Vedde Ash (~12 ka BP), assigned via combined stratigraphic, chronological and geochemical evidence. These layers provide chronostratigraphic markers and a robust framework for correlating and dating Late Glacial sedimentary archives across Central and Northern Europe; the record also opens the possibility of an independent test of Greenland–Europe climate coupling. Connectable as Quaternary tephrochronology and a chronology tool for Central European lake sediments (Tier 2). *Theme 27 · Method 19 · Venue 8 · Connectivity 8 · Recency 10* (created 25 Sep 2026) · DOI: [10.1002/jqs.70120](https://doi.org/10.1002/jqs.70120)

7. Mercury cycling during the last glacial period in Arctic Lake El'gygytgyn, NE Russia

· *Journal of Quaternary Science*, 2026 · **Score 72** One of the longest (~100-kyr) lacustrine mercury-accumulation records in the Arctic, from the ICDP crater lake El'gygytgyn in remote north-eastern Russia. Finding per the abstract: despite the isolated setting, anomalously high background Hg values point to a local, non-atmospheric source — probably Hg migrating upward along faults beneath the lake floor (tectonically mobilised mercury). Centennial- to millennial-scale environmental signals are superimposed on this high background. The work shows that tectonic Hg fluxes can complicate the interpretation of sedimentary Hg records in tectonically active regions. Connectable as a long ICDP drill-core record (a core profile theme) and as a methodological caution for multi-proxy interpretation in rift basins, where tectonic overprinting is likewise to be expected. *Theme 30 · Method 17 · Venue 8 · Connectivity 7 · Recency 10* (created 24 Sep 2026) · DOI: [10.1002/jqs.70118](https://doi.org/10.1002/jqs.70118)

8. Climate variability over the past 12,500 years has shaped vegetation dynamics differently across West African savannas and forests

· *The Holocene*, 2026 · **Score 72** Pollen-based compositional and functional analysis of vegetation dynamics across West African savannas and forests from the Younger Dryas to the present. Finding per the abstract: fossil pollen assemblages were grouped into ecological domains and harmonised with TRY trait records (including specific leaf area, wood density, seed mass); functional dispersion (FDis), squared chord distance and principal coordinate analysis were used to detect patterns. Sahelian and Sudanian savannas are compositionally distinct but only weakly differentiated functionally; functional dispersion increases significantly through time in the Sahel but not in Sudan. Forest assemblages show greater functional dispersion and compositional turnover than savannas. Connectable as an African vegetation–climate study across glacial–interglacial to Holocene timescales — methodologically transferable to East African pollen-based reconstructions and human–environment coupling in the rift. *Theme 30 · Method 16 · Venue 8 · Connectivity 8 · Recency 10* (created 25 Sep 2026) · DOI: [10.1177/09596836261487403](https://doi.org/10.1177/09596836261487403)

9. Climate and paleoseismicity co-recorded in a tectono-karstic Lake: a multi-proxy late Pleistocene–Holocene record from Lake Iffer (Middle Atlas, Morocco)

· *Palaeogeography, Palaeoclimatology, Palaeoecology*, 2026 · **Score 72** ·  title-based Multi-proxy reconstruction from a tectono-karstic lake in the Middle Atlas (Morocco) that co-records climate and paleoseismicity signals across the late Pleistocene and Holocene. Core theme: a North African lake-sediment archive, Quaternary palaeoenvironment, coupling of climate and tectonics — directly connectable to rift-lake questions, where tectonic and climatic signals must likewise be disentangled. Without a visible abstract (Elsevier), hence title-based and provisional. *Theme 30* ·

10. Tree-ring-anchored analog reconstruction of daily climate distributions from instrumental data with Bayesian distributional regression: Application to the European Alps · *Quaternary Science Reviews*, 2026 · **Score 71** ·  *title-based* Analog reconstruction of daily climate distributions from instrumental data, anchored on tree rings and modelled via Bayesian distributional regression, applied to the European Alps. Methodologically at the profile's centre: Bayesian statistics and high-resolution time-series reconstruction — directly citable in methodological work on non-parametric and Bayesian reconstruction approaches. Without a visible abstract (Elsevier), hence title-based; the specific implementation and validation results remain provisional. *Theme 26 · Method 16 · Venue 11 · Connectivity 8 · Recency 10 (created 28 Sep 2026)* · DOI: [10.1016/j.quascirev.2026.110287](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.quascirev.2026.110287)

● Radar

- **Trends in south pole particle concentrations imply Holocene westerly wind strengthening** · *Climate of the Past* · **71** ● · Holocene dust-microparticle records from the South Pole Ice Core (SPC14) as a physical proxy for the Southern Hemisphere westerlies: decreasing concentrations (1.1–5.1 µm) and increasing coarse-particle percentage through the Holocene, interpreted as wind strengthening. Open access. DOI: [10.5194/cp-22-1741-2026](https://doi.org/10.5194/cp-22-1741-2026) · publ. 28 Sep 2026
- **Dating of Late Pleistocene sediments along the coast of Brittany (W France) by OSL and palaeodose estimates with BayLum** · *Quaternary Geochronology* · **68** ● ·  *title-based* · OSL dating of Late Pleistocene coastal sediments with Bayesian palaeodose estimation (BayLum); methodologically connectable to Bayesian luminescence chronology. No visible abstract. DOI: [10.1016/j.quageo.2026.101770](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.quageo.2026.101770) · publ. 21 Sep 2026
- **Climate-driven shifts in lake connectivity and carbon accumulation in the upper Rio Negro Basin evidenced by a multi-proxy record over the past 7000 years** · *Quaternary Science Reviews* · **68** ● ·  *title-based* · Multi-proxy lake-sediment record over 7,000 years on lake connectivity and carbon accumulation; a Quaternary lacustrine archive. No visible abstract. DOI: [10.1016/j.quascirev.2026.110291](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.quascirev.2026.110291) · publ. 22 Sep 2026
- **Stable isotope analysis of freshwater gastropod carbonates from Swanscombe: Insights into climate stability and seasonality during MIS 11c** · *Journal of Quaternary Science* · **68** ● · $\delta^{18}\text{O}/\delta^{13}\text{C}$ on freshwater molluscs (Bithynia, Valvata) from fluvial sediments of the Hoxnian Interglacial (MIS 11c) in the Lower Thames Valley; little systematic change across the thermal maximum, indicating stable environmental conditions. Connectable as an interglacial seasonality study. DOI: [10.1002/jqs.70112](https://doi.org/10.1002/jqs.70112) · publ. 21 Sep 2026
- **Centennial salinity variability recorded in early Holocene deposits in the Yangtze River Delta and implications for hydroclimatic change of the East Asian Summer Monsoon** · *Quaternary Science Reviews* · **67** ● ·  *title-based* · Centennial salinity variability in the early-Holocene Yangtze Delta and its coupling to the East Asian summer monsoon. No visible abstract. DOI: [10.1016/j.quascirev.2026.110293](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.quascirev.2026.110293) · publ. 23 Sep 2026
- **Glaciers fluctuations during the Lateglacial and the Holocene in Georgian Greater Caucasus from ^{10}Be moraine dating** · *The Holocene* · **66** ● · Reconstruction of glacier fluctuations in the Georgian Greater Caucasus via ^{10}Be dating of 51 samples from 12 moraines: one Lateglacial moraine (~16 ka), five Holocene stages (~5.6/2.3/1.5/1.0 ka) and

several Little Ice Age advances; small early-Holocene extent. DOI:

[10.1177/09596836261477276](https://doi.org/10.1177/09596836261477276) · publ. 23 Sep 2026

- **Electron probe microanalysis of extremely fine-grained tephras: new protocols and insights for analyses at the 1 μm scale** · *Journal of Quaternary Science* · **66** ● · A quantitative EPMA-WDS method ($\mu\text{m}/1\text{ nA}$) for geochemical characterisation of ultra-distal cryptotephra in ice cores and marine sediments; validated on the Zavaritskii 1831 cryptotephra. Methodologically connectable to Quaternary tephrochronology. DOI: [10.1002/jqs.70117](https://doi.org/10.1002/jqs.70117) · publ. 25 Sep 2026
- **Redefining Last Glacial Maximum environmental conditions in northeastern Brazil: pollen-based evidence of open and moist-adapted vegetation cover** · *Quaternary Science Reviews* · **65** ● · $\triangle$ title-based · Pollen-based evidence for open, moisture-adapted vegetation during the LGM in north-eastern Brazil. No visible abstract. DOI: [10.1016/j.quascirev.2026.110197](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.quascirev.2026.110197) · publ. 25 Sep 2026
- **Influence of the western Pacific warm pool and East Asian climate on late Holocene typhoon activities affecting Taiwan** · *Quaternary Science Reviews* · **65** ● · $\triangle$ title-based · Late-Holocene typhoon activity around Taiwan and its coupling to the western Pacific warm pool; a palaeotempestology extreme-value question. No visible abstract. DOI: [10.1016/j.quascirev.2026.110282](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.quascirev.2026.110282) · publ. 21 Sep 2026
- **First foraminiferal record and multi-proxy reconstruction of paleoenvironmental changes in the Gulf of Gdańsk (SE Baltic Sea) over the last 5000 years** · *The Holocene* · **64** ● · Multi-proxy record over 5,000 years from the Gulf of Gdańsk: disturbance around 4 ka (storm activity, reduced river discharge), freshening 3–1.7 ka, salinity drop and possible hypoxia around 1.4 ka. Noted as a Holocene multi-proxy coastal study. DOI: [10.1177/09596836261487376](https://doi.org/10.1177/09596836261487376) · publ. 21 Sep 2026
- **Coupling of dust activity and loess accumulation with East Asian summer monsoon precipitation along the lower reaches of the Yellow River during the Last Glacial period** · *Palaeogeography, Palaeoclimatology, Palaeoecology* · **64** ● · $\triangle$ title-based · Coupling of dust activity and loess accumulation to the East Asian summer monsoon during the last glacial. No visible abstract. DOI: [10.1016/j.palaeo.2026.114241](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.palaeo.2026.114241) · publ. 22 Sep 2026
- **Enhanced Last Glacial Aridity in the Western Pampean Plains Inferred From Southern South American Loess** · *Paleoceanography and Paleoclimatology* · — · $\triangle$ Note: this article is the revised version of an earlier paper **retracted** on the same day (retraction of 10.1029/2025PA005304; reason: inconsistencies in parameters derived from grain-size distributions, with the authors reprocessing the data). Content: a multi-proxy reconstruction of dust accumulation in Pampean loess over 43,000 years (luminescence dating, palaeoclimate simulations). Given the retraction history it is listed here with an explicit caveat only and not scored in the regular ranking. DOI (revised): [10.1029/2026pa005524](https://doi.org/10.1029/2026pa005524) · publ. 23 Sep 2026

Regional and temporal fringe: Further Quaternary hits at the profile's edge, noted here only for orientation: a Holocene vegetation study from the Tibetan Plateau (pollen; DOI [10.1016/j.palaeo.2026.114242](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.palaeo.2026.114242)), Holocene human–environment archives from the Great Rann of Kachchh (India; [10.1016/j.palaeo.2026.114240](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.palaeo.2026.114240)), from the Santiago Basin (central Chile; [10.1016/j.quaint.2026.110456](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.quaint.2026.110456)) and from the Pantanal (Brazil; [10.1016/j.quaint.2026.110455](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.quaint.2026.110455)). Two relevant but deep-time *Paleoceanography and Paleoclimatology* papers (a Pliocene Northern Adriatic sapropel-runoff study, [10.1029/2026pa005503](https://doi.org/10.1029/2026pa005503); precession-paced Eocene North Pacific deep-water formation, [10.1029/2026pa005598](https://doi.org/10.1029/2026pa005598)) lie outside the Quaternary window and are noted only for their method (orbital tuning). A Quaternary primary hit from Chew Bahir, Turkana or a direct African Humid Period proxy archive was not found within the 14-day window; the region is served

this week via the Green Sahara modelling study (rank 2), Nyayanga (rank 3), the West African vegetation study (rank 8) and Lake Iffer in the Middle Atlas (rank 9).

Part B — Funding & calls

PAGES — Early-Career Award 2027, deadline 29 Sep 2026. The award recognises outstanding early-career researchers (PhD completed or postdoc, normally up to five years after the doctorate; justified career breaks extend this) for excellent science combined with coordination, outreach and community engagement; the prize includes an invitation to the Open Science Meeting with a conference subsidy. The deadline falls the day after this issue appears. Endorsement

requests (without funding) are reviewed in January, April, July and October. Sources: [PAGES — Awards](#) · [PAGES — Meeting support](#).

DFG — Communicator Award 2027, application deadline 30 Sep 2026. The €50,000 award for science communication is open until 30 Sep 2026. Source: [DFG — Press releases 2026](#).

ERC Starting Grant 2027 — deadline 14 Oct 2026. The call (ERC-2027-STG) is open; submission until 14 Oct 2026, 17:00 Brussels time. Funding up to €1.5 million over five years (plus up to €1 million for start-up costs). For the 2027 round the eligibility window is widened: eligible are those whose doctorate was completed at most ten years before the cut-off date (full 0–10-year window; the official ERC page prevails). Sources: [ERC — Starting Grant](#) · [ERC — Work Programme 2027](#).

Horizon Europe — "Palaeoclimate science for a better understanding of Earth system dynamics" (HORIZON-CL5-2027-01-D1-08). Opening **17 Nov 2026**, deadline **4 Mar 2027**, Research and Innovation Action, budget around **€14 million for about two projects** (roughly €7 million per consortium). Aim per the call text: robust information on palaeoclimate states and events outside the variability of the last few centuries, as a basis for advancing Earth system models. With only two funded projects Europe-wide, competition is fierce; consortium talks should start early. Sources: [Topic page](#) · [CL5 Work Programme 2026–2027 \(PDF\)](#).

ICDP — proposal cycle. The regular annual deadline for full, pre- and workshop proposals is **15 January**; the 2027 cycle is likely to follow the same pattern, though no formal announcement has been made. Workshop calls run through the year. Source: [ICDP — Proposals](#).

DFG — changed framework conditions. No new palaeoclimate-specific call. Relevant for planning: the **programme allowance rises from 22 to 25 percent from 2027**; the next **Priority Programme application round** takes place only at the **end of 2026**, with funding starting from **2028**. Source: [Forschung & Lehre — 25 instead of 22 percent from 2027](#).

Part C — Science policy (DE/EU)

WissZeitVG — amendment in parliamentary deliberation. Following the cabinet decision of 29 July 2026, the bill to modernise fixed-term employment law in academia is in parliamentary deliberation (Committee for Education, Research and Technology Assessment). At the core of the draft are, for the first time, binding **minimum contract terms: three years for doctoral researchers' initial contracts, two years for postdocs**; the maximum fixed-term duration in the postdoc phase is unified. For **student assistants** a minimum term of one year and a raised

maximum fixed-term duration are foreseen. As orientation, not established fact: minimum terms improve the plannability of early contracts, while unifying the postdoc maximum may narrow individual carry-over flexibility; the further parliamentary path and timetable are open. Sources: [BMFTR — Cabinet adopts WissZeitVG amendment](#) · [Forschung & Lehre — WissZeitVG focus](#).

2027 federal budget — parliamentary deliberation in autumn. The government draft has been in place since 6 July 2026. The BMFTR core budget stands at around **€22 billion** — a nominal increase of only about **0.7 percent** over 2026. Real growth is almost exclusively in the special fund for infrastructure and climate neutrality, whose R&D investments rise markedly in 2027 relative to 2026. Bundestag readings run through the autumn. As orientation: the regular budget stagnates in real terms given current wage and material cost increases, keeping the operating situation of the funding organisations under pressure. Sources: [Forschung & Lehre — Only a slim increase for the BMFTR core budget](#) · [Table.Briefings — 2027 budget](#).

DFG cuts at the postdoc level remain in force. Because of high wage increases and rising equipment and consumable costs that the promised annual funding increments do not cover, the DFG has postponed the funding start of new Research Training Group applications and **suspended the approval of postdoc positions**. For postdoc career paths in the geosciences this removes one funding avenue for now, increasing the pressure on individual-grant and EU funding. Source: [Fakultätentag Informatik](#).

Part D — Community & events

- **DEUQUA conference 2026 — 28 Sep to 2 Oct 2026 in Freiburg im Breisgau**, theme "Environmental Records and Landscape Change", with full-day excursions on 28 Sep and 2 Oct (including Black Forest / Vosges glaciation, loess in the Rhine Valley, fluvial dynamics in the Upper Rhine Graben). Opens on this issue's publication day. Source: [DEUQUA 2026](#).
 - **PAGES Early-Career Award 2027** — application deadline **29 Sep 2026**.
 - **DFG Communicator Award 2027** — application deadline **30 Sep 2026**.
 - **ERC Starting Grant 2027** — deadline **14 Oct 2026**.
 - **Horizon CL5 Palaeoclimate call** — opening **17 Nov 2026**, deadline **4 Mar 2027**.
 - **AGU Fall Meeting 2026 — 7 to 11 Dec 2026 in San Francisco**; the abstract deadline (5 Aug 2026) has passed. Source: [AGU](#).
 - **EGU General Assembly 2027** — in Vienna (spring 2027), hybrid; date and abstract deadline are on the EGU page (typically the abstract deadline is mid-January). Source: [EGU](#).
 - **ICDP** — next regular proposal deadline expected **15 Jan 2027**, following the pattern of previous years and not yet confirmed.
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Methodology & sources

The paper review follows the fixed set of criteria (thematic fit, methodological fit, impact/venue, connectivity, recency) and excludes DOIs already listed in a previous issue. Funding opportunities, science policy and events rely on the sources linked in Parts B to D.

On how this issue came about — Crossref access via the browser interface. Direct network access from the compute environment was blocked as in previous weeks (proxy 403).

The Crossref REST API was, however, successfully queried in this run via the integrated browser interface (`fetch()` against `api.crossref.org`). This allowed the systematic ISSN query of the core journals (including QSR, EPSL, GPC, P³, Quaternary Research, JQS, Quaternary International, Quaternary Geochronology, Paleoceanography and Paleoclimatology, The Holocene, Communications Earth & Environment, Nature Geoscience, Nature Communications) with a `from-created-date` filter and `created` sorting, supplemented by thematic queries (paleoclimate, Quaternary lake sediment, East African Rift/Turkana, Chew Bahir, African Humid Period, paleoflood fluvial, Bayesian age-depth chronology, early-warning tipping point, lake water balance, ICDP drilling). Climate of the Past was additionally captured via container-title and prefix queries. For Nature-portfolio and Copernicus titles the Crossref abstract was used where available.

What this means for coverage. Coverage again includes Elsevier and Wiley core journals. Elsevier still provides no abstracts via Crossref; the affected entries are marked $\triangle$ *title-based*, their content statement remains provisional until the original is consulted, and no results beyond the title were fabricated. The dates given are Crossref `created` dates (registration), which can differ from the online publication date by a few days. The genuinely new material this week is concentrated mainly in the period 21–28 September 2026, supplemented by works from the preceding days not yet listed.

GeoNews is an automatically generated digest, published by Dr. Markus L. Fischer, Palaeoclimate Dynamics group, University of Potsdam. The thematic profile follows his research interests; the selection is made by a rule-based workflow, not an editorial team. The digest is an independent literature overview with no connection to the publishers or funding bodies mentioned and does not constitute a recommendation or advice. Corrections and tips are welcome.